

Annual Review — PhD Student

Dempsey Lab · University of Michigan

Complete Parts 1–6 before our review meeting; Part 7 is finalized together during the meeting. Throughout, focus on what was learned, not what was worked on. Companion reading: the Lab Expectations page (DRI rubric).

Name: Year in program:

Program: Review period:

Advisor: Walter Dempsey Date of review:

Part 1 · Last Year's Goals — Accountability Loop

Copy each goal from last year's review and record its outcome. First-year students: skip to Part 2.

Goal 1:

Outcome: Achieved Partially achieved Dropped / pivoted

Goal 2:

Outcome: Achieved Partially achieved Dropped / pivoted

Goal 3:

Outcome: Achieved Partially achieved Dropped / pivoted

If a goal was dropped or pivoted, what did we learn from that decision?

Pivots are expected — research is a stochastic decision process. What matters is what the pivot taught us.

Part 2 · Milestones & Thesis Progress

Completed to date: Coursework Qualifying exams Candidacy / prelim Thesis proposal

Defense scheduled

Next milestone: Target date:

Research progress this year: key results, theoretical developments, methods built, data applications.

State findings, not activity: “the estimator is biased under informative cluster size” beats “ran simulations.”

Part 3 · DRI Self-Assessment

Rate yourself relative to expectations for your year in program, per the Lab Expectations rubric. We will compare notes at the meeting.

	Ahead	On track	Needs focus
Thoughtful implementation — 45%			
Troubleshooting & autonomy — 25%			
Tactical direction — 10%			
Strategic vision — 10%			
Clear communication — 5%			
Lab citizenship — 5%			

Where are you in the DRI handoff, and what is the next capability you want to own?

Part 4 · Research Assistant Performance (if RA-funded this period)

Main technical contributions to the lab or grant project.

e.g., data pipeline curation, large-scale simulation studies, statistical modeling, package development.

Collaboration & deliverables: deadlines, code sharing via GitHub, work with co-investigators or domain experts.

Part 5 · GSI / Teaching Performance (if applicable)

Instructional duties: lab sections, office hours, grading, designing problems.

Part 6 · Professional Development, Service & Career

Dissemination: posters, department seminars, conference talks (JSM, ENAR, NeurIPS, ICML, ...).

Service & community: departmental service, peer review, mentorship of undergrads or newer students.

Career direction: Academia (research) Academia (teaching) Industry Government / nonprofit
 Undecided

One skill to develop next year for that path:

What do you need from me or the lab?

Meeting cadence, funding clarity, introductions, compute, faster feedback, co-author connections — be specific.

Part 7 · Goals for the Coming Year (finalized together at the meeting)

Good goals name a deliverable and a date. "Make progress on Chapter 2" is not a goal; "submit the Chapter 2 paper to ENAR by January 15" is.

Goal 1:

Deliverable:

Target date:

Goal 2:

Deliverable:

Target date:

Goal 3:

Deliverable:

Target date:

Funding & appointment plan for next year:

Target graduation timeline:

Advisor Assessment

Progress vs. timeline: Ahead On track Needs improvement — plan below

Judged against the milestone timeline for the student's year in program, not against expectations in the abstract.

Expectations, per DRI rubric (weights from the Lab Expectations page). Compare with the student's Part 3 self-assessment at the meeting.

	Exceeds	Meets	Needs focus
Thoughtful implementation — 45%			
Troubleshooting & autonomy — 25%			
Tactical direction — 10%			
Strategic vision — 10%			
Clear communication — 5%			
Lab citizenship — 5%			

RA performance: Exceeds Meets Needs improvement N/A

GSI performance: Exceeds Meets Needs improvement N/A

Strengths observed this year.

Growth areas and, if needed, the specific improvement plan with checkpoints.

Student signature

Date:

Advisor signature

Date: